Chapter 2 Summative Assignment: Tire study

A legendary story on college campuses concerns two students who missed an exam because of excessive partying, but they blamed the absence on a flat tire. The professor allowed the students to take a make-up exam in separate rooms. On the exam, the students were asked which tire was flat.

Step 1 Ask a research question.

Do students pick which tire went flat in equal proportions? A common conjecture is that students tend to answer "front right" more often than would be expected by chance.

Step 2 Design a study and collect data.

To test the conjecture, a professor asked 28 students to imagine being in the same situation as the students in the story and pick one of the four tires. The data is summarized in the table below.

Table 1

Front left	**Front right**	**Rear left**	**Rear right**
6	14	4	4

Exercise 3 What are the observational units?

Exercise 4 What is the variable that is measured and recorded on each observation?

Exercise 5 In words, what is the parameter of interest?

Exercise 6 In words, what are the null and alternative hypothesis?

Step 7 Explore the data.

Exercise 8 What proportion of the students picked the right front tire? Is this more than you would expect if students randomly picked one of the four tires?

Exercise 9 Is observing 14 out of 28 picking the front right tire possible if the students are randomly picking between the four tires?

Key Idea 2 3S strategy (Statistic, Simulate, Strength of Evidence). The 3S Strategy will help you investigate how much evidence the sample data provides in support of the research conjecture.

Step 10 Draw inferences.

Exercise 11 Statistic: What is the statistic of interest and what is the symbol that is associated with that statistic called?

Now we will use the One proportion simulator at `https://www.rossmanchance.com/applets/2021/oneprop/OneProp.htm?hideExtras=1`

Exercise 12 Simulate: What values for probability of success (π), sample size (n), and number of samples should be entered into the tool to simulate the study?

Exercise 13 Simulate: What is the center of your null distribution? Does the center you observed make sense? Explain.

Exercise 14 Strength of evidence: Using your simulation, what is the p-value? What does the p-value represent?

Exercise 15 Strength of evidence: Using your simulation, what is the standardized statistic? What does this standardized statistic represent?

Exercise 16 Strength of evidence: Using a theory-based z-test (normal approximation), what is the p-value? Are the validity conditions met?

Exercise 17 Strength of evidence: Do all three methods yield strong evidence against the null hypothesis that students pick the front right tire one-fourth of the time in the long run?

Step 18 Formulate conclusions.

Exercise 19 What conclusions can you draw from the study?

Exercise 20 What are the wider implications of the study? Do you think the conclusions hold true for people in general?

Step 21 Look back and ahead.

Exercise 22 If you were to repeat this study, what improvements would you make? What further research would you propose related to this topic in the future?

Another professor conducted a similar study with a smaller class and found that 7 out of 14 students picked the front right tire.

Exercise 23 Do you expect that this study will yield stronger, weaker, or the same evidence against the null hypothesis? Explain.

Again we will use the One proportion simulator at `https://www.rossmanchance.com/applets/2021/oneprop/OneProp.htm?hideExtras=1`

Exercise 24 Conduct a simulation analysis and produce a p-value. How does this p-value compare to the p-value you calculated for the sample of 28 students?

Suppose you didn't have a preconceived notion that the right front tire would be chosen more often, but instead just wanted to find out if the front right tire was chosen at a rate that was different than one-fourth. Consider the original sample of 28 students.

Exercise 25 In words, what are the null and alternative hypotheses for this new question?

Exercise 26 Conduct a theory-based analysis and produce a p-value. How does this p-value compare to the theory-based p-value you calculated for the sample of 28 students using the original setup?

Exercise 27 Do you have strong evidence against the null hypothesis that students choose the right front tire one-fourth of the time in the long run?